



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

This is a restaurant! Please turn your phone off!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations

Ask your partner:

- Do you use your phone in public places, like a restaurant or a library?
- Do people ask you to turn your phone off because you are too loud?
- How do you react?

Can Do Statements

- I can deal with non-standard requests and refuse politely.
- I can respond politely to suggestions and offers.
- I can express what is necessary.





Let's Explore!

A rude customer is **giving Sarah, the waitress, a hard time*** in Vanessa's restaurant.

* You "*give someone a hard time*" when you bother a person and make their job more difficult.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Steve:** Hello? This is Steve speaking. Yes, it's great to finally speak to you! I wanted to let you know that we are ready for the job! You must absolutely meet our team! We have an incredibly talented group of professionals here. We are all very excited to be on this project. You've got to come to our downtown office to see for yourself! You'll love how creative we are!
- Sarah:** Excuse me, would you mind taking your call outside? Your conversation is bothering other patrons.
- Steve:** Can't you see I'm on the phone? I'm closing a deal here.
- Sarah:** I understand, sir, but this restaurant has a policy about cell phones. Patrons should have their phones on silent mode as a courtesy to others.
- Steve:** I'm one of your regulars. I come here every week for business lunches. Can I finish this call in peace?
- Sarah:** I'm afraid not, sir. I'm going to have to ask you to turn your phone off.
- Steve:** This is ridiculous! I demand to see the manager!





Let's Practice!

The waitress is very patient with this extremely rude customer.

Instructions: Choose the correct answers. Read these sentences aloud. Check the pronunciation with your instructor. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

What can the waitress say to deal with a difficult customer?

1. I demand to see the manager.
2. Excuse me, would you mind taking your call outside?
3. Patrons should have their phones on silent mode.
4. This is ridiculous!
5. May I finish this call in peace?



Let's Practice!

May I suggest ... ?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect word in each sentence. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. I understand but I am what of your regulars!
2. You should turn off your shell phone as a courtesy to others.
3. You have to got to taste our lemon pie.
4. You had better make reservations know.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue between a customer and a waiter.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Role-play a situation at a restaurant. Choose between the following roles:
- Write a dialogue (12-14 lines) about the situation.
- Read the dialogue aloud.
- Change roles with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a dialogue about dealing with difficult customers.

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I offer suggestions and respond politely.

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I express what is necessary and refuse politely.

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I role-play the dialogue in front of others.

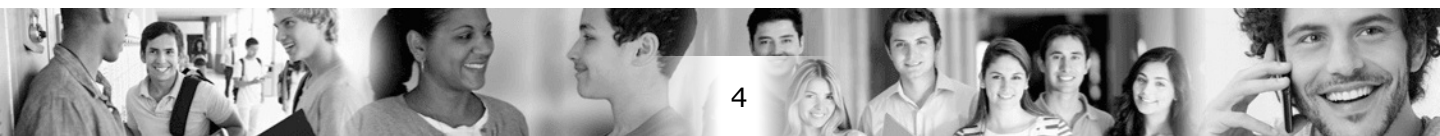
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Student A Role	Student B Role
You are a waiter or waitress. You are very patient and deal with a difficult customer.	You are a rude customer. You have difficult requests for the waiter or waitress.



Target Words

- incredibly** (adverb): to a great degree
e.g. We have an incredibly creative team.
- talented** (adjective): showing talent; gifted; skillful
e.g. Our team is incredibly talented.
- to bother** (verb): to disturb
e.g. You are bothering other customers.
- patron** (noun): a customer at a restaurant or store
e.g. Your loud conversation is bothering other patrons.
- to close a deal** (expression): to conclude a business agreement
e.g. Can't you see I'm on the phone? I'm closing a deal!
- policy** (noun): a rule; guideline
e.g. Our restaurant has a policy about cell phones.
- regular** (noun): a customer who regularly goes to the same restaurant or store
e.g. I'm one of your regulars. I come here every week for lunch.
- to turn something off** (verb): to stop using something, usually an electronic device
e.g. I am going to have to ask you to turn your phone off.





Learning Points

Dealing with Customers

When you work in a restaurant or in a shop, it is important to deal with customers properly.

Remember to respond to their requests politely and to use the modals *could*, *should* or *might* to suggest something.

Here is a list of expressions you can use to deal with customers:

- You might want to ...
- Would you mind ... ?
- You should ...
- You ought to ... (strong request)

Making Requests	Responding to Requests
• You might want to ... • Would you mind ... ? • You should ... • May I ... • You ought to ... (strong request)	• I understand, sir/madam, but ... • I'm afraid not • I apologize, but ...

Examples:

- **Waiter:** *Would you mind turning your phone off?*
- **Customer:** *Can't you see I'm busy?*
- **Waiter:** *I understand, sir, but your conversation is bothering other patrons.*

Expressing What is Necessary

You use modals such as *should* and *must* to express that something is necessary to do.

Should expresses mild obligation or advice.

Must and expressions with *have to* express strong advice.

Examples:

- *Patrons should have their phones on silent mode as a courtesy to others.*
- *You must absolutely meet our team!*
- *You've got to come to our downtown office to see for yourself!*

